

COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE AND REQUIREMENTS

RWANDA e-PASSPORT APPLICATION

OFFICIAL GUIDE AND REQUIREMENTS

Issuing Authority: Directorate General of Immigration and Emigration (DGIE)

Application Platform: IremboGov

Applicable To: Applications submitted within Rwanda and through Rwandan Embassies/High Commissions abroad

1. Purpose of This Guide

This document provides official guidance on the **requirements, eligibility criteria, application procedure, and processing of the Rwanda electronic passport (e-Passport)**. It is intended for use by applicants, embassies, consulates, and authorised service providers.

2. Description of the Rwanda e-Passport

The Rwanda e-Passport is a secure electronic travel document issued to **Rwandan citizens** for international travel. It contains biometric identifiers and complies with international civil aviation and travel document standards.

All passport applications are initiated **online through the IremboGov platform** and finalised through **mandatory in-person biometric capture**.

3. Passport Categories, Validity, and Official Fees

Passport Category	Eligible Applicants	Validity Period	Official Fee (RWF)
Ordinary Passport (50 pages)	Citizens aged 16 years and above	5 years	75,000
Ordinary Passport (66 pages)	Citizens aged 16 years and above	10 years	100,000
Minor Passport (34 pages)	Citizens under 16 years	2 years	25,000
Service Passport	Government officials on official duty	5 years	15,000
Diplomatic Passport	Diplomats and senior state officials	5 years	50,000

4. Eligibility Criteria

1. The applicant must be a **citizen of Rwanda**.
2. Applicants aged **16 years and above** must possess a valid **Rwandan National Identity Card (Indangamuntu)**.
3. Applicants **under 16 years of age** must apply through a parent or a legally recognised guardian.
4. Eligibility for Service and Diplomatic passports is subject to **official government authorisation**.

5. General Application Requirements

All applicants are required to provide the following:

- A completed **e-Passport application form** submitted via the IremboGov platform
- Valid identification documents as applicable
- A recent **passport-size photograph** meeting official specifications
- A valid **email address** and **telephone contact**
- Proof of payment of the prescribed passport fee

6. Category-Specific Requirements

6.1 Applicants Aged 16 Years and Above

- Valid Rwandan National Identity Card (Indangamuntu)
- Uploaded a copy of the National ID
- Passport-size photograph

6.2 Minors (Applicants Under 16 Years)

- Birth certificate
- Passport-size photograph
- National Identity Cards of both parents or legal guardians
- Marriage certificate of parents, where applicable
- Legal guardianship or consent documentation, where applicable

6.3 Service Passport Applicants

- Official recommendation or authorisation letter from a competent government authority
- Mission order or appointment letter
- National ID, where applicable

6.4 Diplomatic Passport Applicants

- Official appointment or nomination letter
- Authorisation from the relevant government ministry or authority

7. Application Procedure

1. The applicant shall create or log in to an account on www.irembo.gov.rw.
2. The applicant shall select **'Immigration and Emigration Services'** and choose the **'e-Passport Application'** option.
3. The applicant shall complete the application form accurately and upload all required documents.
4. The applicant shall pay the applicable passport fee using the prescribed online payment methods.
5. Upon preliminary verification, the applicant shall receive notification regarding biometric capture.
6. The applicant shall appear **in person** for biometric capture at:
 - DGIE offices within Rwanda, or
 - A designated Rwandan Embassy or High Commission abroad.
7. The passport shall be collected from the location where biometric capture was completed, upon notification.

8. Biometric Capture and Processing

- Biometric capture includes a **digital photograph and fingerprints**.
- Fingerprint capture is mandatory for applicants aged **16 years and above**.
- Minors are generally exempt from fingerprint capture.
- Standard processing time is **approximately four to nine working days** after successful biometric capture, subject to verification and operational workload.

9. Administrative Notes

- There is **no officially guaranteed express or same-day passport service**.
- Applicants are advised to submit applications well in advance of intended travel dates.
- Incomplete, inaccurate, or inconsistent information may result in processing delays.
- Embassies and service providers act as **facilitators only** and do not issue passports directly.

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST (ALL CATEGORIES)

RWANDA e-PASSPORT APPLICATION

OFFICIAL APPLICATION CHECKLIST

For Use by Applicants, Embassies, and Authorised Service Providers

Applicant Details

Full Name (as per official records): _____

Passport Category: _____

Application Location: ☐ Rwanda ☐ Embassy / High Commission

1. Eligibility Verification

- ☐ Applicant is a Rwandan citizen
- ☐ Applicant meets age and category requirements
- ☐ Personal details match official records

2. Required Documentation

Mandatory for All Applicants

- ☐ Completed online application via IremboGov
- ☐ Passport-size photograph (white background)
- ☐ Valid email address and telephone contact

Applicants Aged 16 Years and Above

- ☐ Valid Rwandan National Identity Card (Indangamuntu)
- ☐ Uploaded a copy of the National ID

Minors (Under 16 Years)

- ☐ Birth certificate
- ☐ National IDs of parents or legal guardians
- ☐ Marriage certificate of parents (where applicable)
- ☐ Guardianship or consent documentation (where applicable)

Service Passport Applicants

- ☐ Government authorisation or recommendation letter
- ☐ Official mission or appointment documentation

Diplomatic Passport Applicants

- ☐ Official appointment or nomination letter
- ☐ Supporting authorisation from the competent authority

3. Online Application Confirmation

- ☐ IremboGov account created or accessed
- ☐ e-Passport service selected
- ☐ Application form completed accurately
- ☐ All documents uploaded
- ☐ Applicable fee paid
- ☐ Payment confirmation retained

4. Biometric Capture

- ☐ Biometric appointment notification received
- ☐ Applicant appeared in person for biometric capture
- ☐ Original identification documents presented

5. Passport Collection

- ☐ Passport readiness notification received
- ☐ Passport collected at DGIE office or Embassy/High Commission
- ☐ Passport details verified upon collection

ANNEX A

RWANDA e-PASSPORT APPLICATION

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQ)

Purpose: This annex provides official responses to common questions regarding the Rwanda e-Passport application, eligibility, fees, and procedures. It is intended for applicants, embassies, high commissions, and authorised service providers.

1. Eligibility

Q1: Who is eligible to apply for a Rwanda e-Passport?

A1: Only Rwandan citizens may apply. Applicants aged 16 years and above must possess a valid National ID (Indangamuntu). Applicants under 16 years apply through a parent or legal guardian.

Q2: Can I apply for a passport from outside Rwanda?

A2: Yes. Applications may be submitted online via IremboGov, and biometric capture and passport collection are conducted at a designated Rwandan Embassy or High Commission.

2. Application Process

Q3: Where must the application be submitted?

A3: All applications must be submitted online through the official **IremboGov platform**.

Q4: Is physical appearance required during the application?

A4: Yes. All applicants must appear in person for biometric capture at DGIE offices or an authorised Embassy/High Commission.

Q5: What documents are required for adults?

A5:

- Valid Rwandan National ID (Indangamuntu)
- Passport-size photograph (white background)
- Valid contact information (email and phone)
- Proof of payment of the prescribed passport fee

Q6: What documents are required for minors?

A6:

- Birth certificate
- Passport-size photograph
- Parents' or legal guardians' National IDs
- Marriage certificate of parents, if applicable
- Guardianship or consent letter, if applicable

3. Passport Types and Fees

Q7: What passport categories are available?

A7: Ordinary (5 or 10 years), Minor (2 years), Service, and Diplomatic passports. Service and Diplomatic passports require government authorisation.

Q8: How much does a passport cost?

A8: Official fees are:

- Ordinary (5 years): 75,000 RWF
- Ordinary (10 years): 100,000 RWF
- Minor: 25,000 RWF
- Service: 15,000 RWF
- Diplomatic: 50,000 RWF

4. Biometric Capture and Processing

Q9: Do minors provide fingerprints?

A9: Fingerprints are not required for applicants under 16 years; a photograph and supporting documents are mandatory.

Q10: How long does it take to process a passport?

A10: Standard processing is **4 to 9 working days** after biometric capture, subject to verification and operational workload.

Q11: Is express or emergency service available?

A11: No officially guaranteed express service exists. Requests are considered only under exceptional circumstances with official justification.

5. Passport Collection

Q12: Where do I collect my passport?

A12: At the DGIE office or Embassy/High Commission where biometric capture occurred.

Q13: Can someone else collect the passport on my behalf?

A13: Generally, collection must be in person. Exceptions require written consent and identification and are subject to approval by DGIE or the Embassy.

Q14: What should I do if there is an error on my passport?

A14: Report errors immediately to the issuing office for correction. Delayed reporting may complicate rectification.

6. Additional Notes

Q15: What are common reasons for delays?

A15:

- Inaccurate personal information
- Incomplete or unclear documents
- Missed biometric appointments
- High volume of applications

Q16: Can embassies or consultancies guarantee faster processing or approval?

A16: No. Issuance and timelines are determined solely by DGIE.

Q17: Is the old non-electronic passport still valid?

A17: No. All travellers are required to hold a current Rwanda e-Passport.

Q18: Where can official updates be obtained?

A18:

- IremboGov platform
- Directorate General of Immigration and Emigration (DGIE)
- Authorised Rwandan Embassies and High Commissions